Journal studio — bulk JEs and monthly salaries

Journal studio now has Upload bulk JEs, Upload monthly salary JEs and JE templates / saved batches. Use the salary template for one total monthly accrual per operating unit plus several actual salary-payment rows. No employee-level accrual split is required. General JE imports remain available for reviewed compound journals and other purposes.

Salary template fields

Download Salary XLSX or Salary CSV from JE templates / saved batches. Excel sheet name is Salary Journals; preserve all ten headings. Blank templates contain no synthetic transactions. The Excel template exported within the app includes the current ledger/unit lookup; the public blank template contains no client data.

Heading	ACCRUAL row	PAYMENT row
Entry Type	ACCRUAL	PAYMENT
Salary Month YYYY-MM	Earned month, e.g.2026-04	Same earned month being settled, even when paid in May
Operating Unit	Actual active unit code, e.g.JP	Same unit as the corresponding accrual
Entry Date	Blank defaults to month end; or actual reviewed accrual date within the earned month	Actual bank/cash payment date, required
Reference	Blank generates SAL-ACCR-YYYY-MM-UNIT, or provide a stable accrual reference	Actual bank transfer/UTR reference, required; preserve leading zeros as text
Bank Ledger	Leave blank; not used	Actual active INR bank/cash code, e.g.1010
Amount INR	Total reviewed salary accrual for this month/unit	Amount actually paid in this transfer; positive number
Existing Voucher (optional)	Exact already-posted accrual voucher to link instead of creating another	Exact already-posted salary-payable/bank payment voucher to link instead of paying again
Payee (optional)	Optional payroll description	Employee/batch description to help identify the bank transfer
Accounting Review Basis	Source payroll review and no-deduction basis	Bank evidence/payment approval basis

Before upload, use Chart of accounts → Set up salary & PF ledgers to review the salary expense and salary-payable roles. These actual mapped accounts are used automatically; the salary template does not require ledger codes for every accrual. PF is not currently part of this simple payroll format. Where PF/ESI/TDS/other deductions apply, do not put net pay into a gross salary accrual or leave deduction balances unexplained: use the reviewed general compound JE/manual payroll workflow and correct liability splits.

Example: monthly total and several payments

Assume approved April salary with no deductions is INR 30,000. Enter one ACCRUAL row for 2026-04 / JP /30,000. The default accrual date is 30 April 2026. Enter three PAYMENT rows for the same earned month/unit, each 10,000, with their actual bank dates, actual bank ledger and separate real transfer references. Payments may be to different employees or batches.

Final approval posts:

- On 30 April: Dr Salaries and wages 30,000 / Cr Salaries payable 30,000. - On each actual payment date: Dr Salaries payable 10,000 / Cr actual Bank 10,000, with that payment reference.

This produces four JEs, not one fictitious month-end bank payment. If only 25,000 is actually paid,5,000 remains payable. Accrual is an earned-period expense; payments do not expense the salary again. Use one ACCRUAL row for each additional month/unit; the same file can cover all seven historical months. All dates come from the source file, not today's Journal studio date.

Salary payments before the recorded accrual date are blocked. Use the correct reviewed earned-period accrual date; a genuine salary advance needs its own approved advance/payroll treatment. Do not change actual bank dates merely to make a batch pass. A monthly total must not be turned into one aggregate bank withdrawal if the statement contains payments on different dates. A single payment row is appropriate only when it represents an actual single dated transfer/batch amount.

Upload, review and post

1. Journal studio → Upload monthly salary JEs → choose the XLSX/CSV file. Upload stores a pending source batch; no accounting entry is posted.

2. Inspect each row's type, earned month, date, unit, accounts, amount, existing voucher, review status and reason. Invalid/duplicate rows are highlighted. Select a row to read its complete reason.

3. Correct the source where necessary and cancel an unused batch before restaging. Reject unwanted/flagged rows with a reason. Do not reject an actual missing accrual and then approve its payments without a valid existing monthly accrual/link.

4. Enter the review basis and tick the source confirmation, including no PF/other deduction splits for the simple salary template. Approve all valid rows or selected rows. Row approval is a review decision, not posting.

5. Preview reviewed journals. Posting order is chronological, with accruals before payments on the same date, regardless of the file's row order. All proposed journals and existing links must pass monthly and actual payable capacity checks. A failure saves none of the selected postings; the message identifies the issue/source row where applicable.

6. Inspect the complete preview. Confirm post reviewed JEs to save the approved batch. The pending manual Journal studio draft is preserved rather than overwritten by the bulk workflow.

7. Verify salary expense, salary payable and bank in Ledger A/c. For bank reconciliation select All book movements and match the dated salary payment JEs to actual bank withdrawals. Upload/posting does not import bank statements or automatically match them.

8. Rebuild any stale Daily Business Register and review Business Pulse salary mappings. Opex recognises the accrual once; bank payments clear liabilities. Report dates and unit selections remain relevant.

Existing entries and duplicate safeguards

If an accrual or salary-payable payment already exists, supply its exact Existing Voucher, actual date, unit and amount. The accounts must match the reviewed salary roles; an existing payment must use the actual bank/reference. Eligible existing sources are linked with no new JE, including earlier general bulk sources. The source is not allowed to be registered twice.

An existing direct Dr Salary expense / Cr Bank payment is not an accrual-plus-payable settlement. Review/reclassify that original transaction appropriately before creating another salary accrual and payment; linking it as a salary-payable settlement would be incorrect. Legacy 4520 Employee benefits entries also need source-based review; the tool does not infer their salary content from narration.

Only one active monthly total accrual per unit is allowed. Pending/posted source identities, changed-file reimports and active existing bank references are checked. Payments cannot exceed the earned month's dated accrual, even if another month has an unpaid balance; actual salary-payable capacity is also checked so unlinked manual payments do not get paid again. A repeated file does not append the same payroll twice.

Do not change references, earned months or amounts to bypass validation. Correct the original source. Reverse dependent tagged payments before reversing their supporting salary accrual; original journals and audit history are retained. Opening salary liabilities and complex historical corrections require the reviewed opening/general journal workflow, not a new current-period salary expense.

General bulk JE format

Upload bulk JEs uses CSV or an Excel sheet named Journals. Columns: date, reference, branch, narration, debit_account, credit_account, amount, journal_id. Each row supplies one balanced debit/credit pair with a positive INR amount. Use actual active ledger/unit codes and literal values, not formulas. Each source line needs a unique reference.

The optional journal_id combines rows with the same date/unit into one compound voucher, such as reviewed gross payroll/deduction allocations. All rows in a compound group must be approved consistently; a partially rejected group cannot post. General imports do not infer tax/payroll splits or automatically detect every pre-existing manually posted expense. Review source purpose and use dedicated AP/tax/receipt workflows for controlled allocations.

General and salary batches use the same Journal studio review and frozen final-confirmation preview. Saved batches can be reopened from JE templates / saved batches or the existing Bulk import review page. General templates, salary templates and this guide are included with the documentation bundle. Synthetic worked examples are labelled separately and must not be uploaded as live client transactions.